



Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam

A Centre for Civilisational Statecraft

FOUNDING PATRON PROSPECTUS

An Invitation to Stewardship



To preserve the art. To embody the dharma. To shape the future.



नाट्यशास्त्रप्रवर्तकं भरतमुनिं वन्दे।

NĀṬYASĀSTRA GURUKULAM

Custodians of Rasa, Rhythm and Responsibility

A Dhārmic Stream For The Renewal Of Public Life Through Aesthetic Leadership



Dear friend,

Some institutions are established to impart knowledge.
Others arise to preserve a tradition.

A few are entrusted with a more demanding responsibility
to cultivate human beings whose inner discipline can
quietly shape the life of a society.
Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam has been founded in that spirit.

Over the past year, what began as a shared *saṅkalpa* has slowly
taken visible form: a *Pratiṣṭhā Samaroham* that consecrated the
institution, residential immersions that brought together practitioners
from across the country, the emergence of a growing community
of *Yātris*, and the beginning of research that seeks to translate
embodied wisdom into contributions to public life.
Yet these are only the first steps of a much longer journey.

Our aspiration is not merely to establish another institution of the arts.
It is to cultivate custodians—individuals in whom aesthetic refinement,
ethical responsibility, and civilisational imagination become inseparable.
Rooted in the Nāṭyaśāstra and its allied disciplines, we believe that such
formation has the potential to renew not only artistic practice, but
education, leadership, and public life itself.

Every enduring institution is sustained by people who recognise that
some responsibilities belong not to a single generation, but to many.
This prospectus is therefore not a request for support in the ordinary sense.
It is an invitation to participate in the establishment of an institution
intended to contribute, in perpetuity, to the Dhārmic renewal of public
life in India and beyond.

Should this vision resonate with you, I warmly invite you to
walk with us in giving it enduring form.

With respectful regards,

Padma Bhushan Dr. M. B. Athreya
Mentor & Marga Darshak
Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam

*Padma Bhushan Dr. M. B. Athreya is one of India's foremost
management thinkers, educator, author, and institution builder.
Over several decades, he has made enduring contributions to
leadership development, corporate governance, public policy,
and value-based management.*

Rohit Viswanath
Yajamāna & Yojaka
Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam



धर्म्यं यशस्यमायुष्यं हितं बुद्धिविवर्धनम् । लोकोपदेशजननं नाट्यमेतद्विष्यति ॥

न तज्ज्ञानं न तच्छिल्पं न सा विद्या न सा कला । नासौ योगो न तत्कर्म नाट्येऽस्मिन् यत्र दृश्यते ॥

*Nāṭya will foster Dharma, fame, longevity, welfare, and the growth of intellect; it will educate the people.
There is no wisdom, art, learning, device, yoga or action that is not found in Nāṭya.*

AN INSTITUTION CONTRIBUTING,
IN PERPETUITY, TO THE DHĀRMIC
RENEWAL OF PUBLIC LIFE IN
INDIA AND BEYOND—THROUGH
GRADUATES WHO EMBODY THE
SPIRIT OF RĀMA RĀJYAM, WITH
A SĀTVIC BLEND OF DHARMA,
SEVĀ, SELF-TRANSCENDENCE, AND
AESTHETIC LEADERSHIP.



*Rooted in Nāṭyaśāstra and its allied disciplines,
the Gurukulam nurtures custodians of
rasa, rhythm, and responsibility—where
presence is pedagogy, and governance
flows from inner rhythm.*



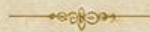
THE FOUNDING VISION STATEMENT
OF NĀṬYAŚĀSTRA GURUKULAM



*Consecrated through the
Pratiṣṭhā Samāroham*



23 NOVEMBER 2025 • NAVI MUMBAI



THE WORK BEFORE OUR GENERATION



❁ Our age has multiplied information.
Yet formation has become
increasingly rare.

❁ Leadership has become increasingly
separated from self-cultivation.
Institutions now ask what people know
long before asking who they are becoming.

❁ Beauty has gradually been
separated from ethics.
The aesthetic and the moral no longer
educate one another.

❁ Civilisations endure when
institutions cultivate custodians
rather than consumers.

This is the work before us.

“ Art refines perception
before it shapes conduct.



WHY THE NĀṬYAŚĀSTRA?

A LIVING KNOWLEDGE TRADITION

The Gurukulam does not approach the Nāṭyaśāstra merely as a classical treatise on performance.

It understands it as a living knowledge tradition—one that brings together aesthetics, ethics, pedagogy, psychology, philosophy, and social order within a single coherent vision of human formation.

It is this integrative character that makes the Nāṭyaśāstra uniquely relevant to the challenges of our own age.



IT IS A PEDAGOGY.

Not merely a performance tradition.



IT IS A DISCIPLINE OF SELF-CULTIVATION.

Not merely artistic excellence.



IT IS A LANGUAGE OF RELATIONSHIP.

Between self, community, and cosmos.



IT IS A SCHOOL OF LEADERSHIP.

Because it forms judgment before action.

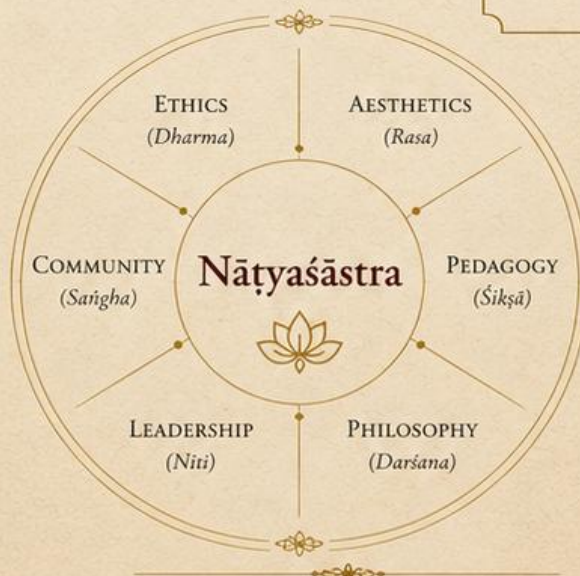


IT IS A CIVILISATIONAL GRAMMAR.

From which institutions may once again learn rhythm, proportion, and responsibility.



*The Gurukulam forms
Player—Performers—Practitioners
who understand Nāṭya as a
discipline of becoming before it is
an act of performance.*



The Gurukulam does not seek to apply modern leadership theories to the Nāṭyaśāstra.

*It seeks to allow the Nāṭyaśāstra itself to shape a new understanding of
leadership, education, and public life.*

FROM SAÑKALPA TO SAÑGHA

The unfolding of a living tradition

1

SAÑKALPA

*A shared resolve to restore
Nāṭya as a living discipline
of human formation.*



2

PRATIṢṬHĀ SAMĀROHAM

23 November 2025

The Gurukulam was ceremonially
consecrated at Shree Subramania
Seva Samaj, Navi Mumbai, affirming
a shared institutional *sañkalpa*.



3

LEADERSHIP & CULTURAL FORMATION IMMERSION

July 2026

Practitioners from across India
gathered for the Gurukulam's first
residential immersion, exploring the
relationship between embodied practice,
leadership, and civilisational renewal.



4

A GROWING COMMUNITY

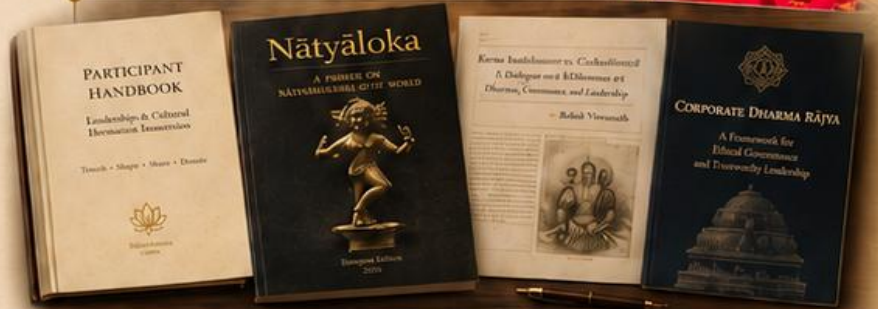
The Gurukulam is becoming a community
of practitioners, scholars, mentors, and
seekers united by a shared commitment
to *Dharma*, *rasa*, and responsibility.



5

RESEARCH & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

Reflection arising from embodied
practice is gradually taking form
as publications, institutional
frameworks, and contributions
to public discourse.



6

TOWARDS A NATIONAL MAṆḌALA

YĀTRĪ NETWORK

The Gurukulam is preparing a
distributed network of trained *Yātris*
who will establish local centres of
learning, carrying the *mārga* into
communities across India while
remaining connected through a
shared pedagogical and ethical
framework.



*A lamp lights
another without
diminishing its
own flame.*



EVERY INSTITUTION BEGINS AS A PLACE.
IT ENDURES BY BECOMING A TRADITION.

THOSE WHO GUIDE THE GURUKULAM

*A tradition flourishes through those who quietly
embody and transmit its deepest values.*



**Padma Bhushan
Dr. M. B. Athreya**

MARGA DARSHAK

Institution Builder

Management Thinker

Leadership Mentor

As the Gurukulam's Marga Darshak, Dr. Athreya has guided the articulation of its long-term vision, ensuring that institutional excellence remains inseparable from Dhārmic purpose. His decades of work in leadership development continue to shape the Gurukulam's evolution.

दृष्टि
VISION



**Dr. Padmaja
Venkatesh Suresh**

CHAIR FOR NĀṬYA PEDAGOGY

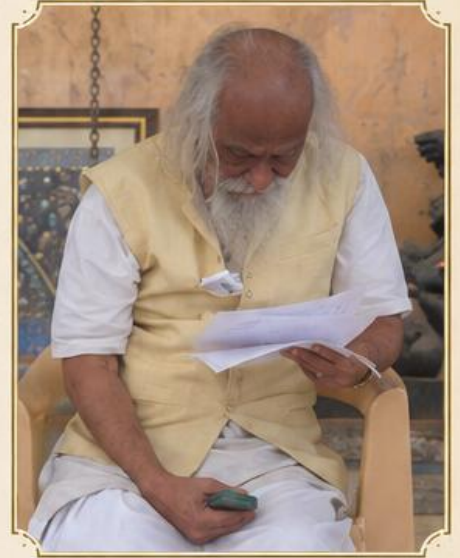
Nāṭya Guru

Researcher

Educator

Through her scholarship, artistic practice, and decades of teaching, Dr. Padmaja has helped shape the Gurukulam's pedagogical vision. Her work anchors the institution's understanding of Nāṭya as a discipline of inner formation, aesthetic refinement, and civilisational continuity.

साधना
PRACTICE



**Sri K. V.
Subrahmonyan**

SPIRITUAL ELDER

*Resident, Sri Ramanasramam,
Tiruvannamalai*

Rooted in the contemplative tradition of Bhagavān Sri Ramana Maharshi, Sri K. V. Subrahmonyan provides the Gurukulam with quiet spiritual guidance. His presence reminds the institution that authentic leadership must ultimately arise from self-enquiry, humility, and inner stillness.

मौन
SILENCE

*The Gurukulam grows through the wisdom, guidance,
and generosity of those who quietly carry forward living traditions.*

THE YĀTRI NETWORK

A living tradition grows not by replication, but by transmission.



The Gurukulam envisions a distributed network of Yātris who carry its spirit into their own communities through study, practice, dialogue, and service. Each Yātri remains rooted in a shared pedagogy while responding creatively to local contexts. The network grows not through institutional replication, but through the quiet transmission of living traditions.

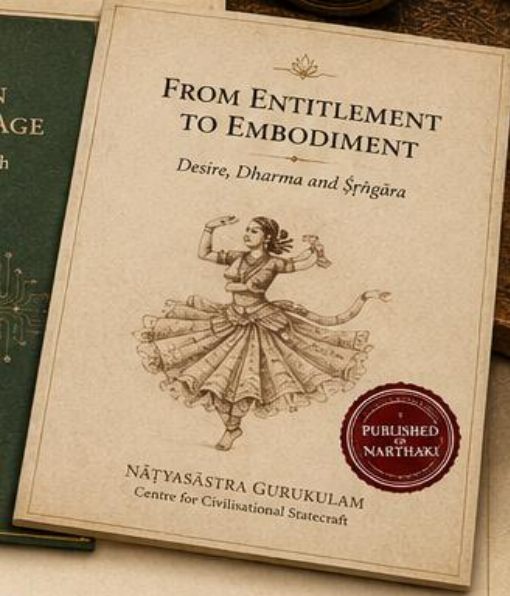
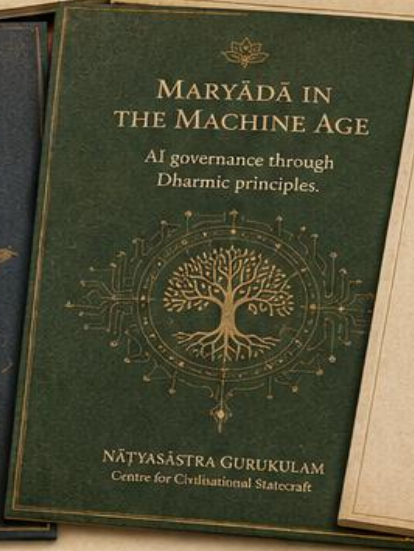
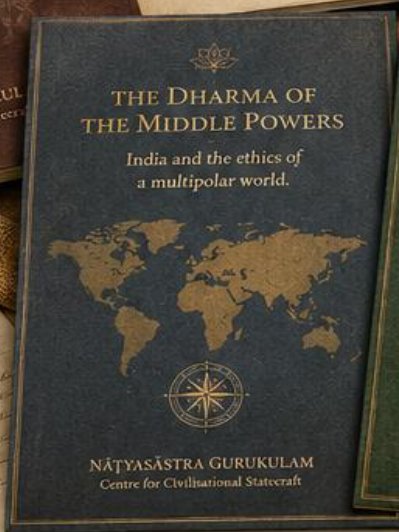
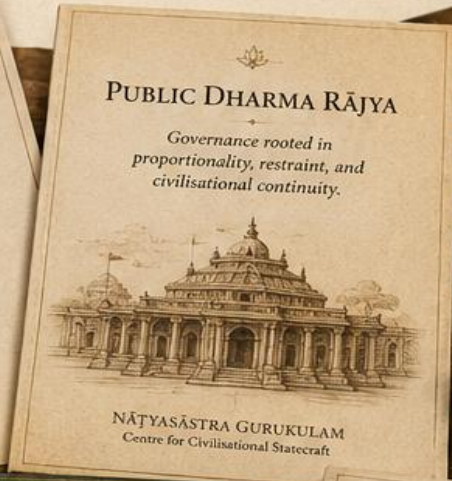
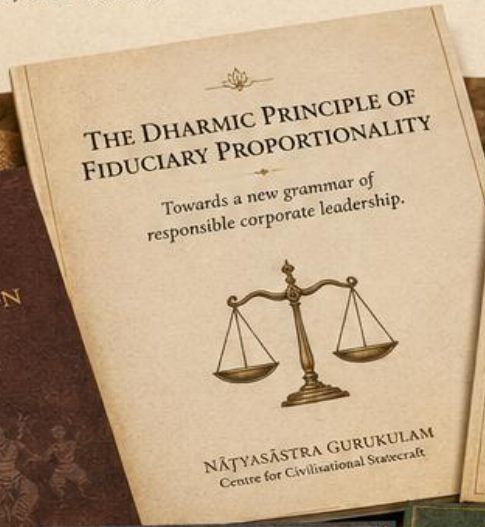
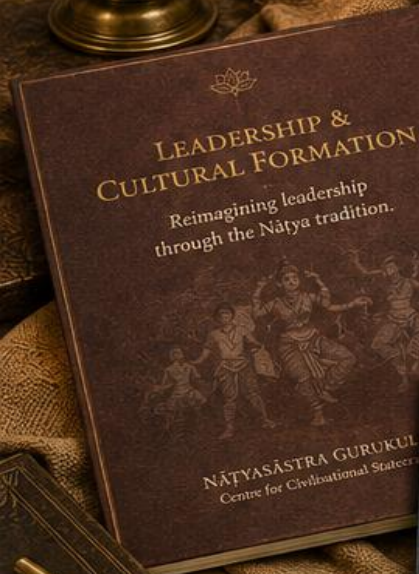
ONE LAMP LIGHTS ANOTHER
WITHOUT DIMINISHING ITS OWN FLAME.

*The measure of a lamp is not its brilliance,
but the light it awakens in another.*

RESEARCH & CIVILISATIONAL STATECRAFT

From embodied practice to institutional imagination.

The Gurukulam's research emerges from practice rather than abstraction. Drawing upon the wisdom of the Nāṭyaśāstra and allied disciplines, it seeks to illuminate questions of leadership, governance, education, institutional design, and public life. These working papers invite dialogue across academia, policy, business, and culture.



LEADERSHIP

Inner mastery that inspires collective purpose.



CULTURE

Aesthetics that refine, ennoble, and unite.



GOVERNANCE

Institutions that are accountable, proportionate, and just.



CIVILISATION

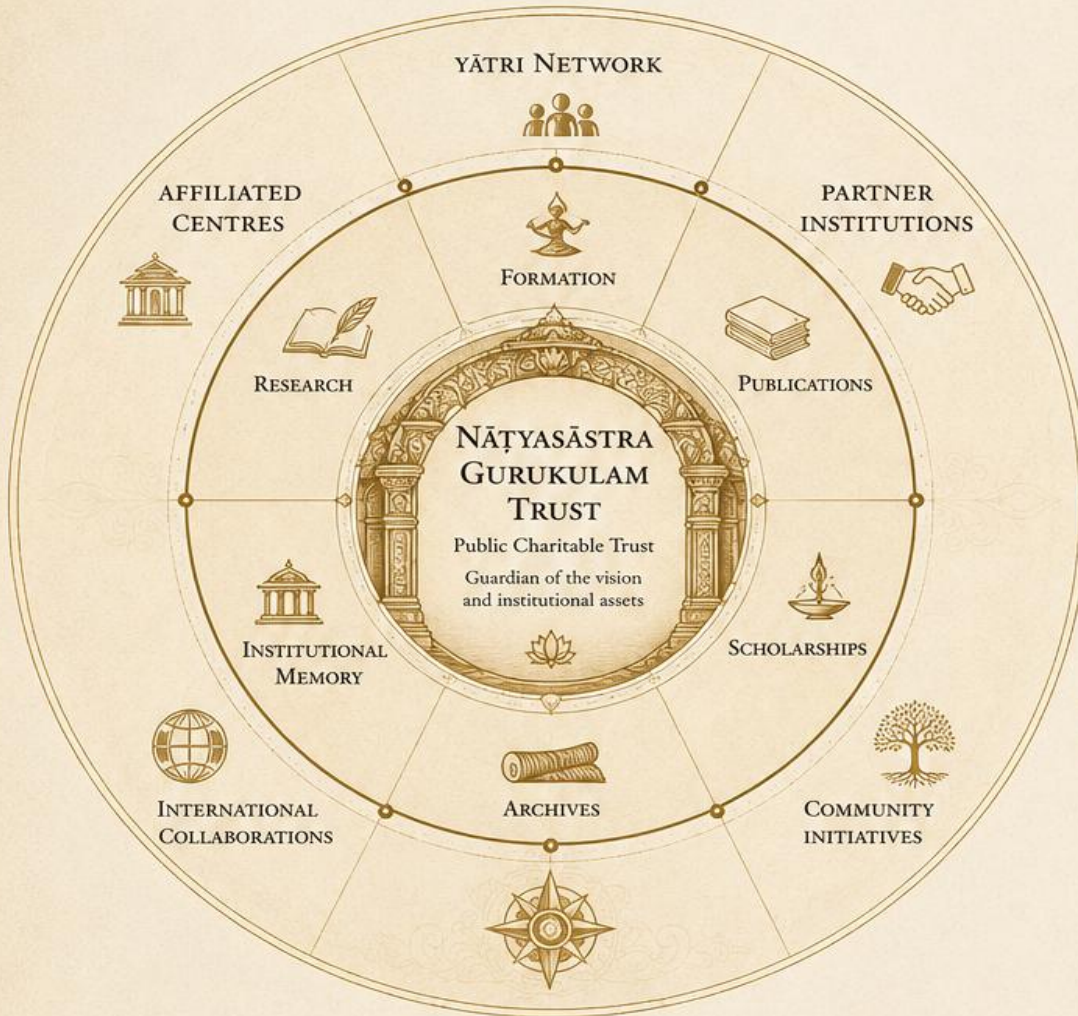
Enduring wisdom that sustains societies across generations.

*The Gurukulam does not seek merely to preserve tradition.
It seeks to place civilisational wisdom in conversation with the challenges of the present.*

STEWARDSHIP

Designed for Continuity. Built for Trust.

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam has been consciously designed as an institution that combines the permanence of a public charitable trust with the agility of professionally managed initiatives. This structure allows the Gurukulam to preserve its founding vision while responding creatively to changing educational and societal needs.



OUR STEWARDSHIP PRINCIPLES



CUSTODIANSHIP

The founding vision is held in trust for future generations.



PROFESSIONAL EXCELLENCE

Execution is supported through contemporary systems of governance and management.



DISTRIBUTED LEADERSHIP

The Gurukulam grows through empowered Yātris and affiliated centres while remaining united by a common pedagogical framework.



FINANCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

Transparent stewardship ensures that every contribution strengthens the institution's long-term sustainability.

OUR STRUCTURE



PUBLIC CHARITABLE TRUST

Guardian of the vision and institutional assets.

Ensures perpetuity, integrity, and mission protection.



PROFESSIONAL INITIATIVES

Research, consulting, publications, leadership development, digital learning, and partnerships.

Provides agility, innovation, and resource generation.



AFFILIATED CENTRES

Local communities of practice led by trained Yātris under the Gurukulam's pedagogical framework.

Extends reach, deepens impact, and nurtures continuity.

INSTITUTIONS ENDURE WHEN PURPOSE IS PROTECTED,
STEWARDSHIP IS SHARED, AND LEADERSHIP OUTLIVES INDIVIDUALS.

BECOMING A FOUNDING PATRON

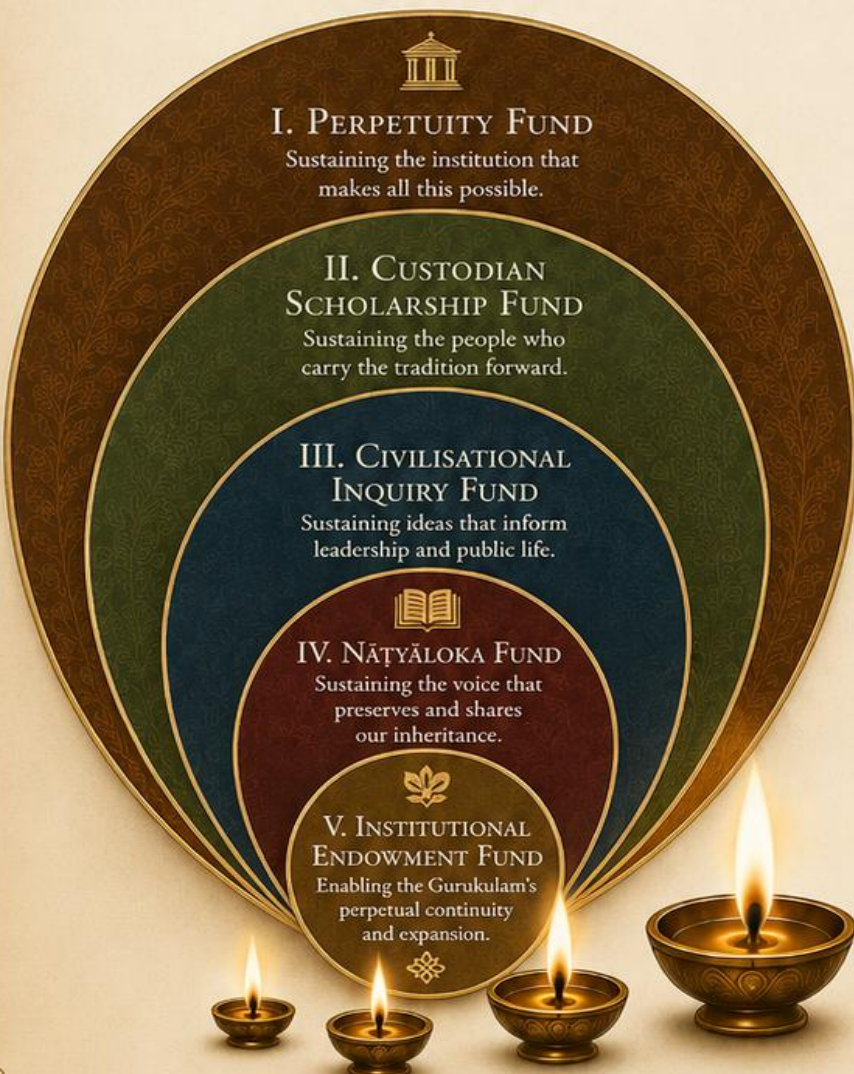
Every enduring institution begins with a small circle of people who recognise that some forms of wealth acquire their highest meaning when placed in service of future generations.

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam

invites such individuals to become its

Founding Patrons—not merely as benefactors, but as custodians participating in the establishment of an institution intended to contribute, in perpetuity, to the Dhārmic renewal of public life.

THE CIRCLES OF PERMANENCE



FOUNDING PATRON GUIDE

There are many ways to become a founding custodian of this institution.

FLAME

PURPOSE

I. THE FIRST FLAME

Scholarships



Enables scholarships for promising practitioners with financial need.

II. THE SHARED FLAME

Research & Publications



Supports research, white papers, publications and the development of institutional knowledge.

III. THE GUIDING FLAME

Residential Immersions



Enables residential immersions and programmes that shape practitioners into custodians.

IV. THE ENDURING FLAME

Faculty Chairs & Archives



Supports faculty chairs, archives, documentation and the preservation of our intellectual heritage.

V. THE ETERNAL FLAME

Institutional Endowment



Builds the endowment corpus that ensures perpetual continuity and expanded impact across generations.

OPPORTUNITIES FOR NAMED ENDOWMENTS



Annual Immersion



Scholarship



Publication Series



Research Fellowship



Faculty Chair



Archive / Library

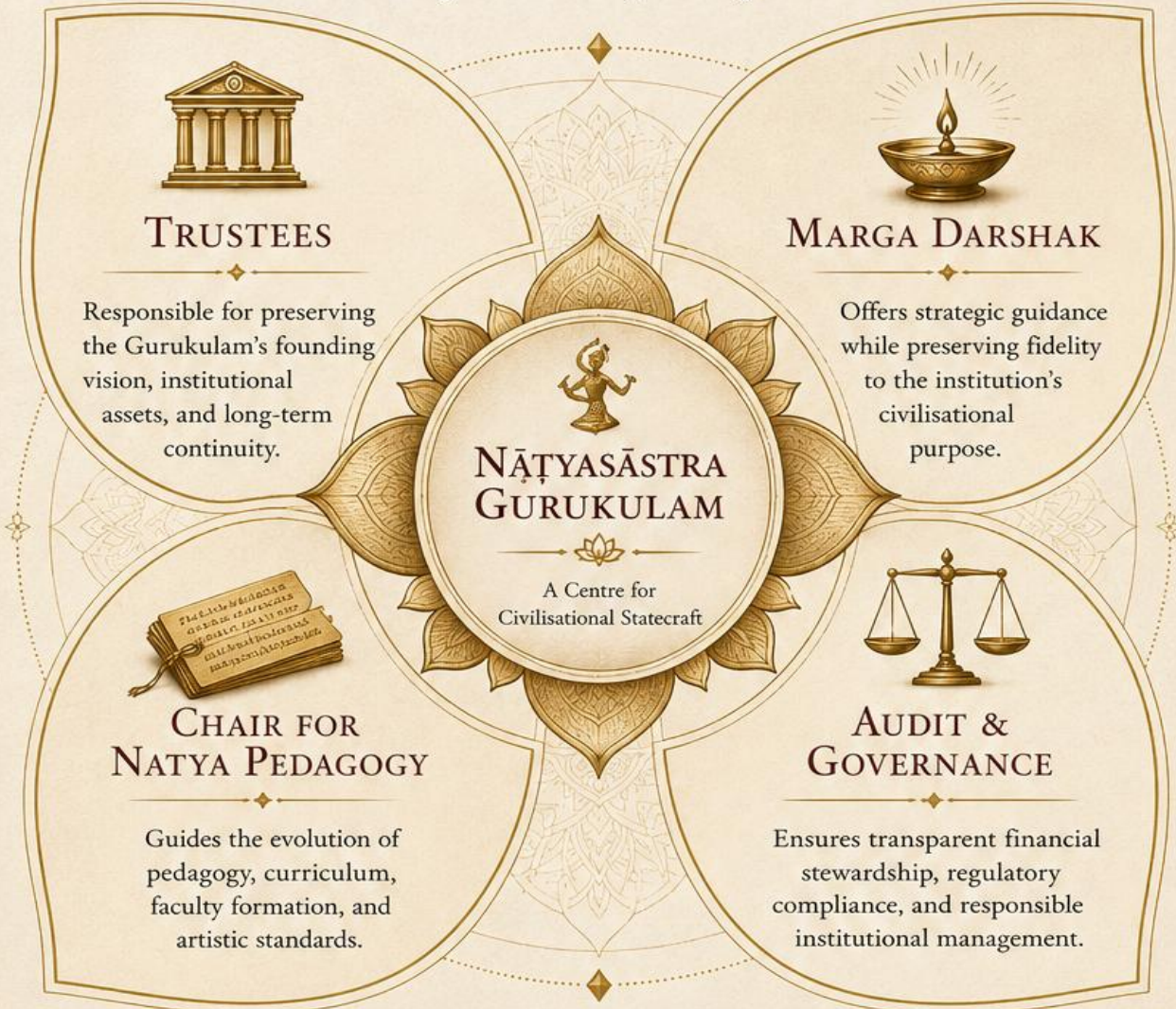
Opportunities for named endowments may be explored in consultation with the Gurukulam.

GOVERNANCE

Stewardship in Service of Continuity

The Gurukulam is governed through a framework that balances vision, accountability, scholarship, and professional execution.

Each role exists not to concentrate authority, but to safeguard continuity across generations.



OUR PRESENT STEWARDS

FUNCTION	PRESENT STEWARD
 Managing Trustee	Rohit Viswanath
 Marga Darshak	Padma Bhushan Dr. M. B. Athreya
 Chair for Natya Pedagogy	Dr. Padmaja Venkatesh Suresh
 Spiritual Elder	Sri K. V. Subrahmonyan

“ Good governance protects an institution not only from failure, but from forgetting its purpose. ”

Śubham



Some institutions are built
for a generation.

Others are entrusted
to generations.

Nāṭyaśāstra Gurukulam
has been founded in that spirit.

May the lamp continue to light another.

NĀṬYAŚĀSTRA GURUKULAM
A Centre for Civilisational Statecraft



NĀṬYAŚĀSTRA GURUKULAM

A Centre for Civilisational Statecraft

A registered Public Charitable Trust
established in Maharashtra, India.

REGISTRATION

Registration No.: E-14411 (Thane)

PAN: AAFTN3404L

12A & 80G: Application in process

CONTACT

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Managing Trustee



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